



The Altenburg Foundation Newsletter

SEPTEMBER
2025



Working for
education,
integration
and maximum
community
impact

Vocational Skills Graduation Day Parade



Catching up with former trainees - now entrepreneurs!

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Christiane and Karl
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The latest cohort of entrepreneur trainees at Mayankho

Dear Friends



It is September and so much has happened since our last newsletter!

Looking at the problems and challenges in the world sometimes makes it hard to stay positive and optimistic. But on a personal level, we know we are so lucky: our eldest son has got married this month, and we have just had a lovely, long summer with lots of wonderful family and friends time.



We believe it is crucial to do whatever we can, even if it is only on a relatively small scale. Within the Foundation we work on achievable goals for our NGOs and students. We support mainly refugees, who have taken shelter in countries neighbouring the conflict zones.

We find that it is best to give people a chance at finding their own solutions to their problems. We are lucky to work with passionate grassroots organisations who remain full of hope for a better future through training and education. As part of this, Brian and I visited Uganda to witness the graduation of the first 100 students of the newly built vocational training centre at the "Planning for Tomorrow" campus. It was amazing how driven and energetic these young people are, even though many are really struggling, especially since the USAID cuts have hit their families hard.



Student-led aerobics sessions at P4T, Uganda

I loved on my visit seeing how students take the initiative, for example with some organising community gardens, while others are leading school aerobics, conducting debates or arranging plastic clean ups. We would love to hear from potential volunteers who would like to visit Kyangwali to share their experiences and skills to help support the students with their endeavours. We can promise curious students willing to welcome and debate with you all evening!

It makes me particularly sad to know that good facilities and great learning opportunities are there for the young people, but too often families just can't afford the final amount of funds to send them to school. We are eager to offer more scholarships, with your help, for the new school year which begins after Christmas. Should you wish, we can keep you updated about the progress of any of the amazing individuals you might be willing to support (see p4). You can contact us through our website or on Instagram.

I also visited CODA, another Kyangwali school for refugees getting great results with minimum financial support, all from the extremely limited means of the families. The whole community is fully behind their learners, and the school land is worked by the parents to grow food to feed the children. I am in awe of their work.

We are developing a good partnership with CODA (see p4), and are really keen to help them secure things the families are simply unable to afford – for example, building proper classrooms and systems that will endure. We would love to hear from you if this is something you might be willing to help us with.

You will also find here updates about our work with our Syrian friends and partners in Lebanon, in Malawi and our ongoing work with refugees in the UK. We hope these updates give you a good idea of the real impact that can be made. Karl and I would like to send you our heartfelt thanks for all your support with the Foundation.

Christiane and Karl



P4T

Our partner P4T's Vocational Skills Training centre has not only opened, but has now graduated its first cohort of nearly 100 trainees!

Christiane was delighted to be able to join in the celebrations of this landmark event. It was great to catch up with earlier trainees who have now set up their own business and are thriving along with their families.



Graduation Day Celebrations



Tailoring business set up by VST graduates

The VST campus (including the secondary school) has now been fully secured with fencing and we have already had a harvest from the agricultural projects that have started. Through the partnership with BRLCF, we have supported P4T in designing the next phases of this amazing work, including purchasing of land to grow food on a scale to fully support all of the learning community - from the nursery, primary and secondary schools to the VST centre, and preparing for the new community clinic and pharmacy.

The guest house refurbishment, funded by the Foundation, will play a key role not only in generating much-needed revenue for P4T, but as a base for volunteers to be able to come and share their expertise with all areas of P4T's programmes. We look forward to longer stays and welcoming more volunteers next year!



Demonstration Garden at P4T's VST

At the secondary school, the Foundation has supported the sponsorship of more than 60 learners through a range of scholarship and extreme hardship support. As part of this scholarship programme, the Foundation has now begun supporting the development of a range of student-led activities including, aerobics, computer support and environmental stewardship.



But there are so many more students that urgently need help. The impact of the cuts of international aid to refugees (following USA and UK withdrawal of funds, among others) has been huge.

Many families are now struggling badly to support even feeding themselves, let alone finding the funds to keeping their children in school. Just £30 a month covers all the costs of a secondary school student, including breakfast and lunch (a crucial support to their family budgets); £40 a month would pay for a student from far distance in the camp to live in the school campus, with all food and requirements.

If you are willing to help, please go to the link below, or get in touch through our website or on Instagram.

www.thealtenburgfoundation.com/select-donation/

CODA

Christiane was also thrilled to visit our newest partner in Kyangwali, CODA school, for the first time earlier this year.



It was wonderful to meet the staff and children, especially to see the young ones in action in competitive debating! In addition to vital support for teacher salaries and their feeding programme, this year the Foundation has funded the purchase of pupil desks, teacher desks/chairs for all classrooms, as well as furniture for their nursery classes.

We were delighted that these furnishings were made in the P4T carpentry workshop by trainers and graduate trainees from the vocational skills programme - keeping the funding within our community's 'eco system' wherever possible is something that matters greatly to us.





Lebanon & Syria

2025 has been a year of hope and optimism for our Syrian friends in Lebanon. With the new Syria slowly arising, families are dreaming for the future in ways that seemed impossible only a few months ago.

Tuyoor al Amal

As they plan their futures when schools and other services become accessible once again in Syria, it is so crucial that the children don't lose momentum with their education. That is why the Foundation has once more funded the Summer School at Tuyoor al Amal in Tripoli, with more than 400 children carrying on with learning and having the chance for computer classes



We were delighted that we were also able to resume having volunteers work with the children to develop their English communication skills and work on their university applications.

In the hot summer months, many of these classes took place in the blooming TAS school garden, which continues to be supported by our lovely friends at **St Benedict's Primary School, Ampleforth**.



One of the most exciting programmes at MAPs (who we have supported with solar power for their HQ and clinics through our wonderful partners Aid Pioneers) is their hugely innovative work in STEM learning through programming and robotics.

MAPs

Their extraordinary, award-winning Team Hope is gearing up for another international competition, and the Foundation is supporting the making of a documentary film telling the story of this amazing group of young robotics engineers as they train and prepare for a life-changing visit to Panama this year.

Watch this space!

Syria

We have spent some time this year alongside our existing Syrian partners in Lebanon scoping out possible projects to support the renewal of Syria through education and livelihoods projects. Amidst the ongoing (yet slowly receding) uncertainty of the situation, we are taking time to make sure that, as ever, our work will have the greatest direct impact at community level. We look forward to sharing more of our ideas later in the year.



MALAWI

Our work with our partners **Mayankho** has continued to develop in the first part of this year. We were able to provide a grant to them which has enabled solar power and water to be connected to their skills and learning centre.



As well as supporting the training work for their business and livelihoods learners, this also means that the team is supporting the local community through providing evening classes and study space for secondary school pupils.

Europe

Now that our incubation funding has drawn to a close, we are really happy that we continue to collaborate with the wonderful team at **Aid Pioneers**.

Germany

For example, we are jointly coordinating the installation of two large solar systems at P4T's programme sites in Uganda, with the support of BRLCF and another German foundation. In 2025 alone, Aid Pioneers will deliver medical goods worth over USD 8 million across four countries and facilitate 14 solar installations - covering an area larger than 18 tennis courts. These will enable over 230,000 additional patient treatments and provide education for more than 18,000 students over the next decade. We are especially proud that many of their projects are anchored in the local partnerships we have established. Looking ahead, we are excited as a Foundation to fund some new solar installations in new locations, hopefully before the end of this year!

UK

The latest development of our work in the UK has been to explore with a prestigious national university scholarship provider the idea of supporting students coming to the UK from conflict-affected contexts. This led to the Altenburg family hosting a dinner gathering of students from a range of universities across London, networking, sharing ideas and support both with each other and with members of the scholarships team.



We hope that we might be able to continue this work in the future to help ensure that students coming to the UK through this programme have access to support, friendship and cultural opportunities to make their experience an even greater success. Please let us know if you have time & would like to help with these activities.